ELECTRICAL SAFETY AND LOCKOUT-TAGOUT (LOTO) PROCEDURE

Document No: SAF-ELT-003 | Revision: 5.1 | Effective Date: 2025-01-05

1. Purpose

This procedure establishes the minimum requirements for the lockout and tagout of energy isolating devices. It is designed to prevent unexpected energization, start-up, or release of stored energy that could cause injury to personnel during maintenance, repair, or servicing of machines and equipment.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all employees, contractors, and visitors who perform servicing or maintenance on equipment where the unexpected energization or start-up could cause injury. It covers electrical, pneumatic, hydraulic, mechanical, thermal, and other energy sources.

3. Lockout-Tagout Sequence

Step 1 – Preparation: Identify all energy sources and the correct isolation methods. Notify all affected personnel.

Step 2 – Shutdown: Turn off the equipment using the normal stopping procedure.

Step 3 – Isolation: Operate the energy isolating device (circuit breaker, valve, disconnect switch) so that the equipment is isolated from the energy source.

Step 4 – Lockout & Tagout: Apply a personal lock and a completed tag to each energy isolating device. Only the person who applied the lock may remove it.

Step 5 – Stored Energy: Release or restrain any residual or stored energy (capacitors, springs, elevated parts, hydraulic pressure, etc.).

Step 6 – Verification: Verify that the equipment is de-energized by attempting a normal start and by testing with a calibrated multimeter or voltage tester. Return controls to the off position after testing.

4. Arc Flash Safety Requirements

- Wear arc-rated PPE appropriate to the calculated incident energy level.
- Maintain the minimum approach distance specified on the equipment label.
- Use only insulated tools rated for the voltage level.
- Never work on live equipment unless it is absolutely necessary and specifically authorized by the Electrical Safety Officer.

5. Removal of Locks and Tags

Locks and tags shall be removed only by the employee who applied them. In exceptional cases where that employee is unavailable, removal may be authorized only by the department manager after verifying that it is safe to do so and after making every reasonable effort to contact the original employee.

6. Training and Authorization

Only trained and authorized employees may perform lockout-tagout. Refresher training is required at least annually or whenever there is a change in equipment, process, or procedure. A current list of authorized employees shall be maintained by the Safety Department.

END OF DOCUMENT – Controlled Copy